Microphone & camera troubleshooting

MICROSOFT TEAMS / DESKTOP APPLICATION

A practical guide for employees using Windows 11 or macOS. Start with the quick checks. Continue only if the problem remains.

START HERE

EXPECTED RESULT If your microphone or camera works after a procedure, stop. You do not need to complete the other procedures.

1 Start with quick checks

1.1 Turn on your microphone or camera

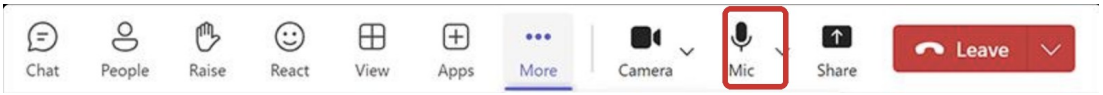


Figure 1. Teams meeting toolbar: microphone and camera controls.

PROBLEM Other participants cannot hear you or see you.

For a microphone problem

1. Find Mic in the Teams meeting controls.
2. On the meeting toolbar, select Mic if the microphone is off.
3. Ask another participant if they can hear you.

For a camera problem

1. Find Camera in the Teams meeting controls.
2. If Camera is off, select Camera to turn on your camera.
3. Ask another participant if they can see you.

EXPECTED RESULT Another participant can hear you or see you.

If the problem continues, go to Section 1.2.

1.2 Examine physical controls and connections

PROBLEM Your microphone or camera does not work.

For a microphone problem

1. If your microphone or headset has a mute switch, set it to the unmuted position.
2. If you use an external microphone or headset, make sure that it is connected to your computer.
3. If the device is disconnected, connect it to your computer.
4. Return to Teams.
5. Ask another participant if they can hear you.

For a camera problem

1. If your camera has a privacy cover, open the cover.
2. If you use an external camera, make sure that it is connected to your computer.
3. If the camera is disconnected, connect it to your computer.
4. Return to Teams.
5. Ask another participant if they can see you.

EXPECTED RESULT Another participant can hear you or see you.

If the problem continues, go to Section 2.

2 Select devices in Microsoft Teams

Use these procedures if the quick checks do not correct the problem.

2.1 Select your microphone

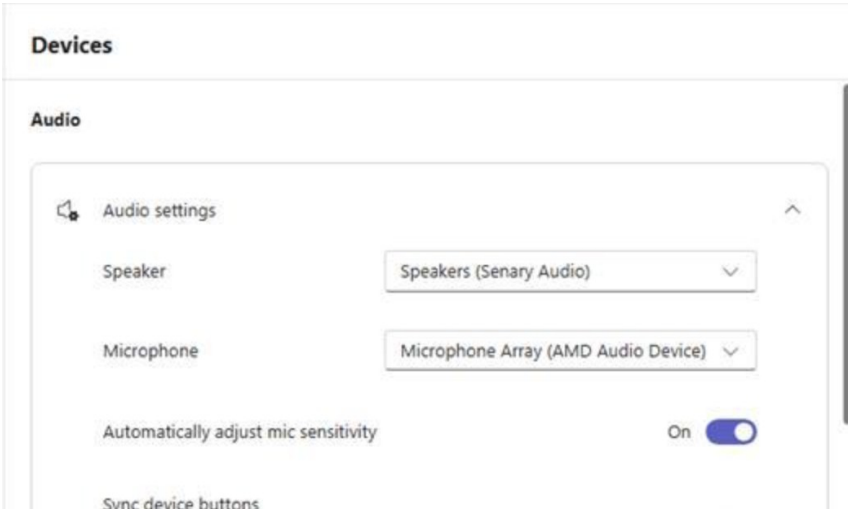


Figure 2. Teams device settings: microphone and camera selection. Interface may vary by Teams version.

PROBLEM Teams does not use the microphone that you want to use.

1. In the upper-right area of the main Teams window, select Settings and more (three dots).
2. Select Settings.
3. Select Devices.
4. Find Microphone in Audio settings.
5. Select the microphone that you want to use.

If Make a test call is available

1. Select Make a test call.
2. Record a short message when the Test Call Bot tells you to speak.
3. Listen to the recorded message.

If Make a test call is not available

1. Join a Teams meeting with another participant.
2. Turn on your microphone.
3. Ask the participant if they can hear you.

EXPECTED RESULT You can hear your recorded message, or another participant can hear you.

If the problem continues, go to Section 3.1 (Windows 11) or Section 4.1 (macOS).

2.2 Select your camera

PROBLEM Teams does not use the camera that you want to use.

1. In the upper-right area of the main Teams window, select Settings and more.
2. Select Settings.
3. Select Devices.
4. Find Camera in Video settings.
5. Select the camera that you want to use.
6. Make sure that your image appears in the video preview.

EXPECTED RESULT Your image appears in the video preview.

If the problem continues, go to Section 3.2 (Windows 11) or Section 4.2 (macOS).

Interface labels can change with Teams updates. The steps in this guide refer to the desktop application.

3 Allow device access in Windows 11

Use the procedure for the device that does not work.

3.1 Allow microphone access



Figure 3. Windows 11 microphone permissions. The desktop-app permission control may be farther down the page.

PROBLEM You cannot use your microphone in Teams.

1. Select Start.
2. Select Settings.
3. Select Privacy & security.
4. Select Microphone.
5. If Microphone access is off, turn it on.
6. If Let apps access your microphone is off, turn it on.
7. If Let desktop apps access your microphone is off, turn it on.
8. Open Teams.
9. Select Settings and more.
10. Select Settings.
11. Select Devices.
12. Find Microphone in Audio settings.
13. Select the microphone that you want to use.

Verify the microphone

If Make a test call is available, select it. Record a short message and listen to the recording.

If Make a test call is not available, join a meeting and ask another participant if they can hear you.

EXPECTED RESULT You can hear your recorded message, or another participant can hear you.

If you cannot change a permission, contact IT support. If the problem continues, go to Section 5.3.

3.2 Allow camera access

PROBLEM You cannot use your camera in Teams.

1. Select Start.
2. Select Settings.
3. Select Privacy & security.
4. Select Camera.
5. If Camera access is off, turn it on.
6. If Let apps access your camera is off, turn it on.

7. If Let desktop apps access your camera is off, turn it on.
8. Open Teams.
9. Select Settings and more.
10. Select Settings.
11. Select Devices.
12. Find Camera in Video settings.
13. Select the camera that you want to use.
14. Make sure that your image appears in the video preview.

EXPECTED RESULT Your image appears in the video preview.

If you cannot change a permission, contact IT support. If the problem continues, go to Section 5.3.

4 Allow device access in macOS

Use the procedure for the device that does not work.

4.1 Allow microphone access

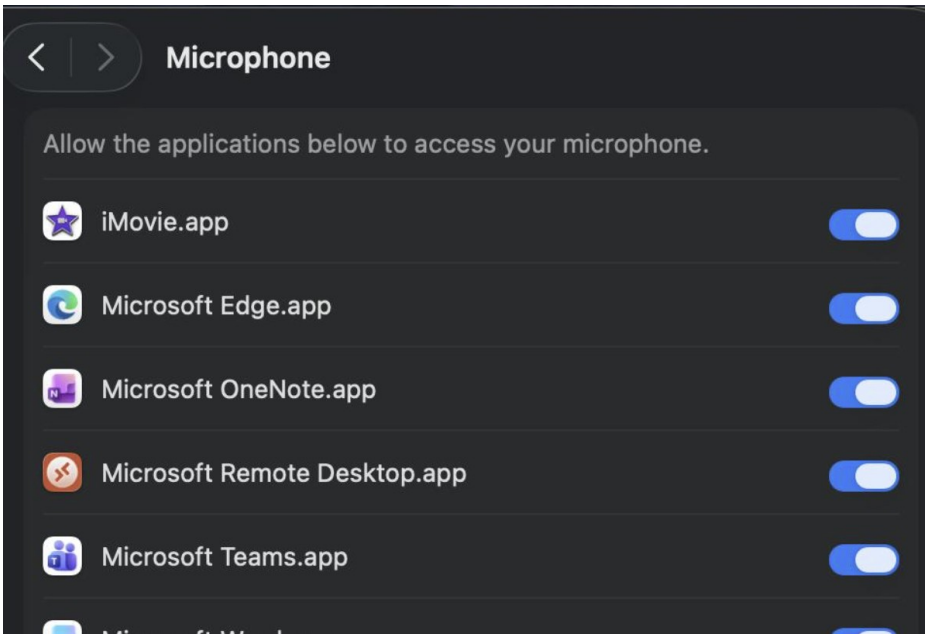


Figure 4. macOS microphone access: Microsoft Teams in the application list.

PROBLEM You cannot use your microphone in Teams.

1. Open the Apple menu.
2. Select System Settings.
3. Select Privacy & Security.
4. Select Microphone.
5. Find Microsoft Teams in the application list.
6. If microphone access for Microsoft Teams is off, turn it on.
7. Open Teams.
8. Select Settings and more.
9. Select Settings.
10. Select Devices.
11. Find Microphone in Audio settings.
12. Select the microphone that you want to use.

Verify the microphone

If Make a test call is available, select it. Record a short message and listen to the recording.

If Make a test call is not available, join a meeting and ask another participant if they can hear you.

EXPECTED RESULT You can hear your recorded message, or another participant can hear you.

If Microsoft Teams is not in the application list

1. Open Teams.
2. Try to use your microphone.
3. Open System Settings.
4. Select Privacy & Security.
5. Select Microphone.
6. Look for Microsoft Teams again.

If Microsoft Teams is still not in the list, contact IT support.

If macOS tells you to quit Teams

1. Quit Teams.
2. Open Teams again.
3. Select Settings and more.
4. Select Settings.
5. Select Devices.
6. Find Microphone in Audio settings.

Do the microphone test again. If you cannot change the permission, contact IT support.

If the problem continues, go to Section 5.3.

4.2 Allow camera access

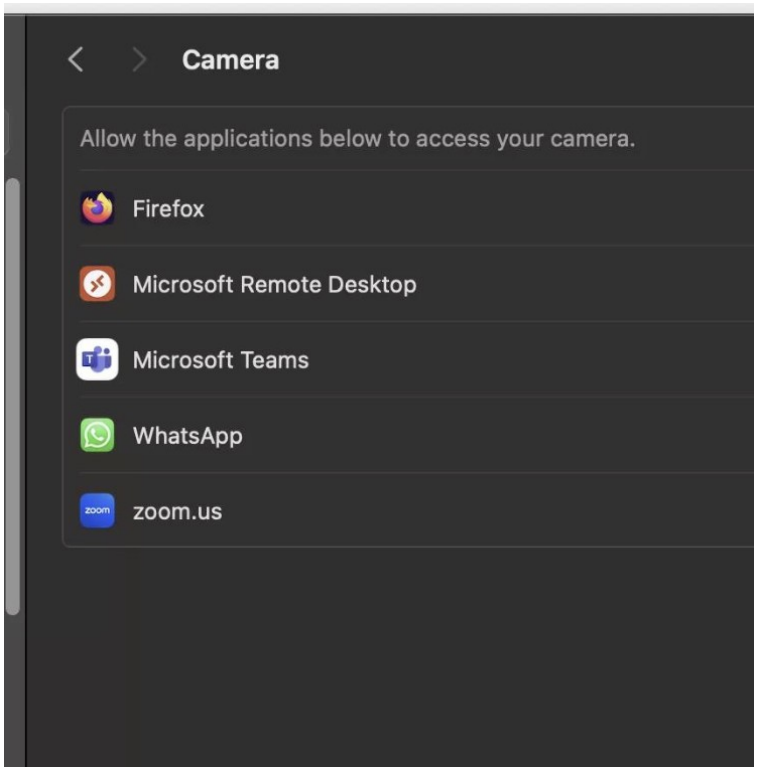


Figure 5. macOS camera access: Microsoft Teams in the application list.

PROBLEM You cannot use your camera in Teams.

1. Open the Apple menu.
2. Select System Settings.

3. Select Privacy & Security.
4. Select Camera.
5. Find Microsoft Teams in the application list.
6. If camera access for Microsoft Teams is off, turn it on.
7. Open Teams.
8. Select Settings and more.
9. Select Settings.
10. Select Devices.
11. Find Camera in Video settings.
12. Select the camera that you want to use.
13. Make sure that your image appears in the video preview.

EXPECTED RESULT Your image appears in the video preview.

If Microsoft Teams is not in the application list

1. Open Teams.
2. Try to use your camera.
3. Open System Settings.
4. Select Privacy & Security.
5. Select Camera.
6. Look for Microsoft Teams again.

If Microsoft Teams is still not in the list, contact IT support.

If macOS tells you to quit Teams

1. Quit Teams.
2. Open Teams again.
3. Select Settings and more.
4. Select Settings.
5. Select Devices.
6. Find Camera in Video settings.
7. Make sure that your image appears in the video preview.

If you cannot change the permission, contact IT support. If the problem continues, go to Section 5.3.

5 Verify the result or contact IT

5.1 Verify your microphone

1. Open Teams.
2. Select Settings and more.
3. Select Settings.
4. Select Devices.
5. Find Microphone in Audio settings.
6. Make sure that Teams uses the microphone that you want to use.

If Make a test call is available

1. Select Make a test call.
2. Record a short message when the Test Call Bot tells you to speak.
3. Listen to the recorded message.

If Make a test call is not available

1. Join a Teams meeting with another participant.
2. Turn on your microphone.
3. Ask the participant if they can hear you.

EXPECTED RESULT You can hear your recorded message, or another participant can hear you.

5.2 Verify your camera

1. Open Teams.
2. Select Settings and more.
3. Select Settings.
4. Select Devices.
5. Find Camera in Video settings.
6. Make sure that Teams uses the camera that you want to use.
7. Make sure that your image appears in the video preview.

EXPECTED RESULT Your image appears in the video preview.

5.3 Contact IT support

PROBLEM Your microphone or camera does not work after you complete the procedures.

Contact your organization's IT support team. Give the team this information:

- Your operating system: Windows 11 or macOS
- The device that does not work: microphone, camera, or both
- Whether the device is built into your computer or connected externally
- The exact error message, if one appears
- The procedures that you completed
- The result of your microphone test or camera preview

Do not change other system settings unless IT support tells you to do so.

DOCUMENT NOTES

Portfolio sample | Version 2.2 | 20 October 2026

Sources: Microsoft Support (Teams audio/video device settings; Windows camera and microphone permissions); Apple Support (Control access to microphone and camera on Mac); ASD-STE100 Issue 9 (2025).

Editorial approach: controlled procedural language informed by ASD-STE100. This document is not certified as fully ASD-STE100 compliant. Interface behavior has not been verified by live device testing.

FIGURE SOURCES AND LIMITATIONS

Figures 1–5: cropped screenshots from the project's existing screenshot archive (Teams_Troubleshooting_Cropped_Screenshots.zip). The archive identifies them as crops of user-supplied screenshots. Original publication URLs, permissions to republish, and software-version dates were not documented in the archive. Verify these before public distribution. Figures are examples; controls can differ by app version and organization policy.